

successful finance businesses. We've seen it over and over again throughout history.

And not all Rothschilds are successful bankers. Lionel Walter Rothschild, 2nd Baron Rothschild, was a zoologist, born in 1868. At age 21, he reluctantly went to work for the family business. Nineteen years later, he was finally allowed out. He started a zoological museum and funded expeditions around the world. He formed the largest zoological collection ever amassed by a private individual.

He was the first to describe a rare giraffe, which was named *Giraffa camelopardis rothschildi*. Another 153 insects, 58 birds, 17 mammals, 3 fish, 3 spiders, 2 reptiles, 1 millipede, and 1 worm also carry his name. He famously drove a carriage harnessed to 6 zebras to Buckingham Palace to prove that zebras could be tamed.

In 2000, 23-year-old Raphael de Rothschild died of a heroin overdose in New York City.

David Mayer de Rothschild is a 32-year-old billionaire environmentalist and adventurer.

And Nathaniel Philip Rothschild, age 40, is said to have generated approximately \$600 million from his stake in the hedge fund Atticus Capital and the launch of Vallar PLC, an investment company focused on mining.

The point is that the Rothschild family is made up of diverse individuals with varying abilities, just like yours. Yet they have been able to hold on to significant wealth for 200 years. They've done it by creating, nurturing, and sustaining a family culture that appreciates expertise in high finance. In the early days, this meant strategic marriages, forcing family members into the family business, and other, more extreme measures that would not be prudent today.

But they answered the question of what it means to be a Rothschild, and they continued to answer that question through the generations as the answer changed. They maintained a firm identity and successfully passed along the ability to generate new wealth in the family business.

The Rothschild family identity was carefully developed and nurtured from the beginning. Its model of expanding the family business by placing family members in strategic locations was followed by other Jewish